COMPETITOR LANDSCAPE · SAMPLE REPORT

Client Co.

B2B transportation spend management software · focus market DACH · generated automatically

Anonymised sample. All company names are replaced with letters (Company A, B, …), and locations are reduced to countries. Scores, structure and method are unchanged.

Executive summary

Company A is the only primary threat in DACH. It is a German startup with 12 employees and 7M in funding. It sells AI freight invoice audit, the same job as the client. Eight watch-list companies follow, mixing TMS vendors (Company B, Company E, Company F, Company H), audit startups (Company C, Company D) and an outsourced service (Company I). The market is crowded: 40 competitors, mostly substitutes. The client faces medium buyer power and high supplier power. Platform owners and TMS/ERP gatekeepers control integration and can bundle audit features.

40	1	8	11	6
competitors in report	primary threats	on watch	platform owners	funded in last 24 months

What this means

- Watch Company A closely. It is a funded German rival with 7M, aimed at the same AI invoice reconciliation market as the client.
- Integration is a risk. Platform owners control schemas and bundle audit modules, so the client should secure connectors with TMS and ERP systems that its buyers use.
- Monitor global players such as Company AA, Company AC and Company AD for DACH market entry. All three sell carrier invoice audit, and none has a presence found in DACH yet.

Market position

Buyer power is medium. Buyers have many alternatives, including platform modules and managed audit services. Switching costs and in-house options are medium, and pricing is comparable across vendors. Supplier power is high. TMS, ERP and WMS platforms control schemas and authentication, and 11 platform owners bundle audit or spend modules. Company L launched an Intelligent TMS in August 2025 with invoice validation and spend analytics. The client depends on these gatekeepers for data access.

Buyer power: MEDIUM

How easily customers can switch or push on price.

- alternatives — HIGH: 40 competitors found, including 35 substitutes, 3 direct rivals and 11 platform owners with their own audit or spend modules. Managed audit services also exist. (our data)
- switching cost — MEDIUM: Switching costs are moderate to high when integrated with ERP, TMS and EDI, and data onboarding is a burden. Some vendors offer pre-built connectors or go-live without

integration. (industry source)

- price sensitivity — MEDIUM: Vendors use comparable per-shipment or savings-linked pricing, e.g. $0.25–$0.85 per audited shipment. No data measures buyer negotiation or discounting. (industry source)
- in house option — MEDIUM: Buyers can use ERP/TMS modules, BI or spreadsheets, but internal builds must cover invoices, rates, disputes and posting. No data on how often buyers do this. (industry source)
- buyer concentration — LOW: About 180,000 SMB and lower-mid-market organizations versus 2,800 strategic enterprises. Large enterprises hold more bargaining power, but there is no client-specific customer distribution. (industry source)

Supplier power: HIGH

How much data, platform and integration providers control this market.

- data access — MEDIUM: Carriers and networks control EDI/API formats, credentials and onboarding; VAN fees run about $500–$5,000 per month and partner integrations $5,000–$25,000, but data comes from many counterparties. (industry source)
- integration gatekeepers — HIGH: TMS/ERP/WMS platforms control schemas and authentication; API connections cost $5,000–$15,000 each, and 11 platform owners among competitors bundle audit or spend modules. (our data)
- supplier concentration — UNKNOWN: Research found no data on the concentration of providers of key inputs. (our data)
- forward integration — HIGH: Company L launched an Intelligent TMS in August 2025 with invoice validation and spend analytics; Company AO and Company AP also bundle invoice auditing. No carrier or ERP examples were found. (industry source)

Primary threats (1)

1. Company A — score 84.3

rivalry, new entrant

What they do: German startup offering an AI platform that automates verification of freight documents and financial/invoice processes for road freight.

Market (DACH): local – HQ Germany · Focus: core business

Why it matters: Company A is a direct rival and a new entrant. It is based in Germany, like the client, and automates freight invoice reconciliation with AI. It has 12 employees and 7M in funding. Its headcount growth is unknown.

Employees 12 · HQ Germany · Founded – · Funding 7M · Last round Venture (Round not Specified), 2026-11-01 · Headcount 12m –

Evidence:

- “Company A erhält 6,4 Millionen Euro frisches Kapital. Die KI-Plattform automatisiert die Prüfung von Transportdokumenten” (news article / startup directory)
- “Company A uses AI to understand and verify freight documents, automating more than 90% of checks, preventing overpayments” (news article / startup directory)

Score breakdown: R 0.92 (focus core x1) · S 0.47 · M 1 · C 1 (growth ignored (<20 employees))

Watch list (8)

Rank · company · score · found as · what they do · employees · funding · focus · market

2. Company B · 63.4 · substitute · Freight audit and payment solution automating invoicing, compliance checking and settlement for shippers. · 12,000 employees · major module · active in market

3. Company C · 62.5 · rivalry, new entrant (unsure) · AI-powered software combining invoice auditing, claim management, and parcel spend analytics for logistics teams. · – employees · core business · local

4. Company D · 62.5 · substitute, new entrant · German startup that uses AI to audit carrier parcel invoices and generate evidence-based correction/credit packages for shippers. · – employees · core business · local

5. Company E · 58.8 · substitute · Transportation management platform for shippers/carriers including a dedicated freight audit and payment hub. · 1,400 employees · 2.1B · major module · local

6. Company F · 57.3 · substitute · German TMS vendor offering freight cost management and automated freight audit/invoice checking software. · 710 employees · 41.7M · major module · local

7. Company G · 57.1 · rivalry (unsure), substitute, new entrant · German startup building AI agents that automate repetitive supply-chain workflows, including pallet account reconciliation. · 16 employees · 1.7M · major module · local

8. Company H · 54.4 · substitute · TMS for shippers with a transport cost management module covering calculation, auditing and reporting. · 500 employees · major module · local

9. Company I · 53.1 · substitute · Outsourced freight invoice audit and cost-control service. · 42 employees · core business · local

Peripheral (17)

10. Company J · 47.3 · substitute · ERP-integrated TMS module that handles freight settlement and invoice verification. · 112,000 employees · side feature · local

11. Company K · 44.9 · substitute, new entrant (unsure) · AI document-processing solution that automatically audits freight invoices. · 59 employees · major module · local

12. Company L · 44.9 · substitute · Intelligent TMS for enterprise shippers covering procurement, execution, visibility and freight audit in one platform. · 780 employees · 1.1B · side feature · active in market

13. Company M · 44.6 · substitute · German modular logistics software including freight cost calculation and clearing for shippers and carriers. · 53 employees · major module · local

14. Company N · 44.3 · substitute · TMS and logistics software provider whose Transportation Manager includes financial settlement and freight auditing. · 2,500 employees · side feature · active in market

15. Company O · 43.8 · substitute · ERP-integrated solution for automated freight invoice auditing against estimated or contracted costs. · 36 employees · major module · local

16. Company P · 43.8 · substitute · Platform for manufacturers to manage freight cost accounting end-to-end including invoice checking and credit note handling. · 350 employees · major module · local

17. **Company Q** · 42.6 · substitute · 3PL offering outsourced freight bill audit and payment services. · 50,000 employees · side feature · active in market

18. **Company R** · 42 · substitute · TMS for manufacturers and wholesalers to manage carriers, rates and shipments, including cost tracking by carrier/route. · 16 employees · major module · active in market

19. **Company S** · 39.1 · substitute · TMS covering order entry through freight invoicing and controlling. · 400 employees · side feature · local

20. **Company T** · 39 · substitute · Cloud supply chain platform offering TMS, freight procurement and freight invoice auditing. · 4 employees · major module · active in market

21. **Company U** · 34.7 · substitute, new entrant · Austrian startup that added a 'Freight Audit AI' module checking incoming deliveries and freight invoices for accuracy. · 26 employees · 1.5M · side feature · local

22. **Company V** · 34.5 · substitute · Shipping invoice analysis tool that normalizes carrier invoices and flags cost discrepancies for e-commerce shippers. · 71 employees · 20M · side feature · active in market

23. **Company W** · 33.9 · substitute · Outsources freight invoice auditing and freight cost optimization. · 190 employees · side feature · local

24. **Company X** · 24 · substitute, new entrant (unsure) · AI logistics tool that reads freight invoices and other shipment documents, cross-checks them, and flags discrepancies for shippers. · 2 employees · side feature · active in market

25. **Company Y** · 17.8 · substitute (unsure) · European B2B freight platform providing instant multimodal pricing, routing and booking, now deepening AI capabilities. · 25 employees · 5M · side feature · active in market

26. **Company Z** · 15.8 · substitute (unsure), new entrant (unsure) · Dutch startup whose AI works through invoices, contracts and deals to find billing leaks and recover money. · – employees · major module · location unknown

Global players without a presence in your market (yet)

Companies with relevant products whose data shows no presence in DACH yet. Scores include a 0.8 discount. Watch them for market entry.

1. **Company AA** · 54.7 · substitute, new entrant · Freight audit software that checks carrier invoices against contract and shipment evidence and submits disputes. · HQ Czech Republic · 70 employees

2. **Company AB** · 53.1 · substitute · Supply chain platform providing freight spend analytics and visibility insights for shippers. · HQ Singapore · 230 employees

3. **Company AC** · 50.9 · substitute, new entrant (unsure) · AI-powered carrier invoice audit and recovery software that checks invoices against contracts and shipment data. · HQ United Kingdom · 500 employees

4. **Company AD** · 50 · rivalry, new entrant (unsure) · Provider of transportation spend management and freight audit services. · HQ United States · – employees

5. **Company AE** · 47.8 · substitute · Freight audit and payment outsourcing provider with spend visibility platform. · HQ United States · 910 employees

6. **Company AF** · 46.3 · substitute · Technology service minimizing transport costs via automated freight auditing. · HQ United States · 230 employees

7. Company AG · 44 · substitute · Freight and parcel audit recovery service provider. · HQ United States · 100 employees

8. Company AH · 40.9 · substitute · AP automation platform that reconciles and pays carrier invoices. · HQ United States · 350 employees

9. Company AI · 39.2 · substitute · Freight invoice auditing software that matches carrier invoices to shipment quotes across all modes. · HQ United States · 64 employees

10. Company AJ · 36 · substitute, new entrant (unsure) · Offers an AI freight invoice audit service that reads carrier bills and matches them to rate contracts, BOLs and PODs. · HQ India · – employees

11. Company AK · 34.3 · substitute · Freight auditing software with parcel and freight modules for automating carrier invoice reconciliation. · HQ United States · 24 employees

12. Company AL · 34.2 · substitute · Freight audit & payment intermediary consolidating carrier invoices for shippers. · HQ Netherlands · 23 employees

13. Company AM · 31.4 · substitute · AP automation platform module that audits carrier/freight invoices against POs. · HQ Sweden · 890 employees

14. Company AN · 30.7 · substitute, new entrant (unsure) · AI agent platform that audits freight invoices against contracted rates, BOLs and PODs for shippers managing transportation spend. · HQ United States · 3 employees

Method

Pipeline: company website → verified profile (every field backed by a quote) → Porter search for rivals, substitutes and new entrants in English and the focus market's language (Perplexity, quotes checked in code) → Apollo enrichment → AI judge per company with company data and evidence (quotes checked in code) → buyer and supplier power research → scoring in code → human approval.

Score = 100 × confidence × (0.6 × relevance + 0.2 × size + 0.2 × momentum) × platform multiplier × market factor. Relevance and momentum are weighted by how central the job is to the competitor (core business 1.0, major module 0.8, side feature 0.5). Unknown size is left out, not counted as small.

Force weights: rivalry 1, substitute 0.9, new entrant 0.6 (adjusted by buyer power). Platform owners × 1.1 (supplier power). Confidence: verified 1.0, unsure 0.7.

Market (DACH): local = HQ in the market; active = HQ elsewhere, but a market domain, a market version of the own website (hreflang tag, /de/ pages, de. subdomain or .de domain, checked in code) or own website pages in the market language; no presence found = known HQ elsewhere and no market signal (score × 0.8); location unknown = no company data, no discount. A missing signal does not prove absence.

Tiers: 70+ primary threat, 50–69 watch, below 50 peripheral. Breakdown codes: R relevance, S size, M momentum, C confidence.

Not assessed in this version: customer segment (company size of the competitor's customers).

Sources (market research)

5 cited sources: vendor product pages, an industry pricing analysis and a platform press release. Links removed in this sample.